

GRC ANALYST Minimum Requirements to Apply

Governance, Risk & Compliance | Target: Rs.4-7 LPA | Best Work-Life Balance in Cybersecurity | Zero Coding Needed

What does a GRC Analyst actually do? GRC stands for Governance, Risk, and Compliance. As a GRC Analyst you write and maintain security policies, conduct risk assessments, ensure the company follows frameworks like ISO 27001, NIST, and India's DPDP Act, perform security audits, manage vendor risk, and generate compliance reports for leadership. Zero coding required. Heavy on documentation, analytical thinking, and communication. Best pay-to-effort ratio in cybersecurity for someone who doesn't want to code.

SALARY — GRC Analyst India 2026

Company Type	Role	Fresher Pay	3 Year Pay
TCS, Wipro, Infosys	GRC Analyst	Rs.3.5 - 5 LPA	Rs.7 - 10 LPA
Accenture, Capgemini, Cognizant	GRC Consultant	Rs.5 - 7 LPA	Rs.9 - 13 LPA
Deloitte, KPMG, EY, PwC (Big 4)	Risk & Compliance Analyst	Rs.6 - 8 LPA	Rs.12 - 18 LPA
BFSI (HDFC, ICICI, Axis, SBI)	Information Security GRC	Rs.6 - 9 LPA	Rs.12 - 20 LPA
Startups and MSSPs	Compliance Analyst	Rs.4 - 6 LPA	Rs.8 - 14 LPA

CERTIFICATIONS — Minimum to Apply (All Free)

DO NE	Certification	Provider	Priority	Where to Get (All Free)
■	ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)	ISC2	MUST HAVE	isc2.org/certifications/cc — free exam
■	Introduction to Cybersecurity	Cisco NetAcad	MUST HAVE	netacad.com — register free
■	Cybersecurity Essentials	Cisco NetAcad	MUST HAVE	netacad.com — covers compliance concepts
■	IBM Cybersecurity Fundamentals	IBM SkillsBuild	MUST HAVE	skillsbuild.org — GRC frameworks covered
■	Google Cybersecurity Certificate	Google/Coursera	MUST HAVE	Coursera financial aid — apply today, approved in 3 days
■	Cyber Threat Management	Cisco NetAcad	MUST HAVE	netacad.com — risk and threat management focused
■	IBM Security Analyst Fundamentals	IBM SkillsBuild	Strong to Have	skillsbuild.org — IBM badge on LinkedIn
■	Fortinet NSE 1 + NSE 2	Fortinet	Strong to Have	training.fortinet.com — 5 hours total, do in one sitting
■	Ethical Hacker	Cisco NetAcad	Strong to Have	netacad.com — understanding attacks helps risk assessment
■	Linux Essentials	Cisco NetAcad	Nice to Have	netacad.com — even GRC teams need basic Linux

GRC ANALYST — TryHackMe Rooms

Complete MUST HAVE rooms before applying | Free rooms only until you subscribe for premium month

TRYHACKME ROOMS — Minimum to Apply

DO NE	TryHackMe Room	Free?	Priority	Why It Matters for GRC
■	Pre-Security Path	FREE	MUST HAVE	Foundation knowledge — networking, Linux, web basics required even for GRC roles
■	Defensive Security Intro	FREE	MUST HAVE	Security controls and frameworks — the core of GRC policy work
■	MITRE ATT&CK;	FREE	MUST HAVE	GRC teams use ATT&CK; for threat modelling and risk assessments
■	Vulnerability Management	FREE	MUST HAVE	Risk rating, CVE triage, remediation tracking is core GRC work
■	Cyber Threat Intelligence	FREE	MUST HAVE	Threat landscape understanding needed for risk assessments
■	Security Operations	FREE	MUST HAVE	Understanding operations helps GRC teams write better policies
■	Intro to SIEM	FREE	MUST HAVE	GRC teams oversee SIEM deployment and compliance monitoring
■	Cyber Kill Chain	FREE	Strong to Have	Understanding attack lifecycle is essential for risk assessments
■	Pyramid of Pain	FREE	Strong to Have	IOC and threat knowledge for GRC risk classification
■	Diamond Model	FREE	Strong to Have	Threat modelling framework used in GRC risk assessments
■	Phishing Analysis Fundamentals	FREE	Strong to Have	Social engineering is a major GRC risk category in India
■	Unified Kill Chain	FREE	Nice to Have	Advanced threat modelling for mature GRC programs
■	Cyber Security 101	FREE	Nice to Have	Broad security overview — helps GRC professionals speak tech fluently

GRC FRAMEWORKS — Study These Before Your Interview

GRC Framework	What It Is	Why You Need to Know It
ISO 27001	International standard for information security management systems	Most asked about in Indian GRC interviews — BFSI and IT companies audit against this
NIST CSF	US framework for cybersecurity risk management	Used by MNCs and GCCs in India — 5 functions: Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, Recover
DPDP Act 2023	India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act	Brand new Indian law — most freshers don't know it — massive differentiator if you do
ISO 27005	Information security risk management standard	Specifically for risk assessment — used alongside ISO 27001
PCI-DSS	Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard	Essential for BFSI GRC roles — any company handling card payments follows this
SOC 2	Service Organisation Controls — trust services framework	Used by SaaS and cloud companies — growing demand in Indian GCCs
CIS Controls	Center for Internet Security top 18 controls	Practical control framework — used in smaller companies without ISO budget

GRC ANALYST — 5 Goated Projects

Pick 2 to build before applying | All free tools | Put everything on GitHub with a proper README

5 GOATED PROJECTS — Pick 2 to Build Before Applying

DO NE	Project Name	What You Build	Tools / Stack	Why Recruiters Love It
■	ISO 27001 Gap Analysis Report	Pick a fictional or real small company. Conduct a full gap analysis against ISO 27001:2022 controls. Document each gap, risk rate it as High/Medium/Low, write a remediation roadmap with timeline and ownership. Present as a professional PDF report.	ISO 27001:2022 checklist (free online) , Word or Google Docs , Excel for gap tracker , PDF export	<i>ISO 27001 is the most common GRC framework in Indian companies. A real gap analysis report is what GRC analysts are hired to produce. Having one on GitHub before your first job is exceptional.</i>
■	Security Policy Documentation Suite	Write 5 professional security policies in proper format: Acceptable Use Policy, Password Policy, Incident Response Policy, Data Classification Policy, and BYOD Security Policy. Each should have purpose, scope, definitions, policy statements, exceptions, and review date.	Word or Google Docs , SANS policy templates (free at sans.org/information-security-policy) , GitHub for version control	<i>Policy writing is 40% of GRC work. A suite of 5 professional policies on GitHub is something almost no fresher has. Shows you can do the actual job, not just talk about it.</i>
■	Risk Register + Risk Assessment Tool	Build an Excel or Python tool that maintains a risk register with risk ID, description, likelihood (1-5), impact (1-5), risk score (L x I), risk owner, mitigation status, and residual risk. Populate it with 20 realistic information security risks. Auto-calculate risk ratings and generate a management-ready heat map report.	Python + Pandas + Matplotlib or Excel with macros , ReportLab for PDF if using Python , GitHub	<i>Risk registers are used daily in every GRC team. A working automated tool shows both GRC knowledge and basic technical skill — a rare combination at fresher level.</i>
■	DPDP Act 2023 Compliance Checklist	Research India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 thoroughly. Create a comprehensive compliance checklist for a fictional e-commerce company. Document each requirement, current compliance status, gaps, and a remediation roadmap. Write a 3-page executive summary explaining business impact.	DPDP Act 2023 text (meity.gov.in — free) , Word/PDF , Excel compliance tracker	<i>DPDP Act is brand new and most GRC freshers and even professionals don't know it deeply. Being the only candidate who can speak to India's new data protection law is a massive differentiator — especially at BFSI and tech companies.</i>
■	Third Party Vendor Risk Assessment Framework	Create a vendor risk assessment framework from scratch. Define risk categories (data security, compliance, operational, financial). Build a scoring questionnaire with 30 questions. Assess 3 fictional vendors using the framework. Produce a risk-rated vendor report with recommendations for each.	Excel or Python , Word/PDF for report , ISO 27001 vendor assessment section for reference	<i>Third party risk management is a growing and well-paid GRC specialisation. A documented assessment framework shows structured analytical thinking that consultants at Big 4 are hired to produce.</i>

PROJECT BUILD CHECKLIST — What Every GitHub Project Must Have

DON E	Requirement	Why It Matters
■	Clear README.md with project title and description	Recruiter reads README first — blank README = closed tab immediately
■	Problem statement — what problem does this solve?	Shows you understand real GRC problems, not just completed an exercise
■	Framework references — ISO 27001, NIST, DPDP Act etc	Shows you know the actual standards GRC teams work with
■	Sample output — a PDF report or Excel file in the repo	Gives hiring managers a deliverable to evaluate — makes it real

■	Professional formatting — looks like a real work document	GRC work is documentation-heavy. Sloppy formatting kills applications.
■	Methodology section — how did you approach this?	GRC is analytical. Showing your thinking process is as important as the output.